Thong Pham

Software Engineer | LLM Evaluation | Applied Machine Learning

ThongPhamBusiness@gmail.com | (714) 487-3430 | Las Vegas, NV
linkedin.com/in/tpdatascience | github.com/YouKnowJP

EXPERIENCE

Mercor March 2025 - Present

Software Engineer & Tooling | San Francisco, CA

- Built Python tooling using GPT-5, Gemini, and other LLM APIs to validate dataset and label quality for AI labs, increasing testing throughput by approximately 40%.
- Designed Snowflake-to-Hex pipelines and dashboards for model performance and label coverage, reducing manual data processing by approximately 25%.
- Engineered intake, quality assurance feedback, reviewer handoffs, and merge workflows; standardized acceptance criteria and maintained post-evaluation defect rates below 1%.
- Served as a subject matter expert for LLM evaluation, clarifying requirements and edge cases for reviewers and the Strategic Project Lead.

Software Engineer LLM

- Resolved hundreds of LLM and data issues weekly across Python, Java, and C/C++ services, including API integrations and rate limiting; maintained a first-pass fix rate above 99%.
- Collaborated with research scientists and product managers on implementation-ready specifications and acceptance criteria, reducing feature iteration time by 20%.
- Reviewed evaluator outputs and provided actionable feedback to improve reviewer consistency and adherence to project guidelines.

Kashmir World Foundation September 2024 - February 2025

Machine Learning Engineer Intern | Richmond, VA

- Applied XGBoost, PyTorch, and OpenCV to more than 200,000 audio/video clips, achieving 91.6% classification accuracy through data ingestion, hyperparameter tuning, and deployment.
- Used exploratory data analysis, random forests, correlation analysis, and feature selection to improve interpretability of signal-based datasets for domain experts.
- Built Power BI and Tableau dashboards to communicate modeling insights and species-behavior trends to conservation researchers and decision-makers.

Stealth Startup February 2023 - June 2024

Software Engineer | Irvine, CA

- Developed LLM-based financial applications in Python, including prompt design, API orchestration, and output post-processing for transaction-data workflows.
- Built evaluation scripts for report generation and risk/exception handling to detect degradations as prompts and application logic evolved.
- Created a Python regression test harness, curated transaction scenarios, and converted production bugs into repeatable pre-deployment tests to reduce recurring release issues.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder June 2024 - December 2025

M.S. Computer Science | Machine Learning specialization | GPA: 4.0 / 4.0 | Boulder, CO

University of California, Irvine September 2019 - December 2022

B.A. Business Economics | Irvine, CA

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, R, Java, C/C++, SQL.

Machine Learning: TensorFlow, scikit-learn, Keras, PyTorch, Seaborn, OpenCV, XGBoost.

Tools: Git, CI/CD, Docker, Airtable, Power BI, Tableau, Excel, Google Sheets, Google Workspace, Hex.

Data and Cloud: AWS S3 and EC2, Google Cloud Platform, Snowflake.

Languages: English (native), Vietnamese (native), Spanish (intermediate).